gasoline formulations, since it reduces emission levels of various pollutants. However, a ‘zero’ emissions vehicle such as an electric or a hydrogen car represent an even greener solution. Promoting mass transit could be regarded as environmentally preferable alternative to electric vehicles, and the environmental impacts associated with mass transit could perhaps be reduced by placing a greater reliance on telecommunications. It means, there are different levels of solutions possible, with each succeeding solution having a higher degree of organizational complexity, and a more formidable set of institutional and economic obstacles. Here, the most environmentally desirable solution involves changing transportation systems rather than specific technological components (for example going for a more efficient internal combustion engine).

A true holistic view implies a unified consideration of production and consumption activities. The supply side and demand side requirements need to be treated in an integrated way. This implies a new way of looking at products, as well as new patterns of industrial organisation. The opportunities for linking technology development and product design with holistic thinking have not been fully explored, but examples are beginning to appear in different sectors of the economy. For instance, pesticide use has declined dramatically where farmers have adopted *integrated pest management* (IPM) schemes involving crop rotation, and the use of natural predators.[27] Such cases have been cited in India also by the recent studies of the farmers’ practices. Due to the success of these new methods, chemical companies are no longer simply supplying pesticides to farmers, but are also providing expertise on how to use those chemicals in conjunction with better field design and crop management. Thus, we see services/ knowledge substituting the chemicals.

In the energy supply sector, similarly, many utilities are providing *energy audit* services, and are promoting customer use of energy-efficient equipment, instead of constructing new generating plants. After all, energy is not used for its own sake, but rather for the services it provides, such as heating, lighting, and transportation.[28]

The idea of integrated pest management in the chemical sector, and demand-side management in the utility industry, can be applied in a more general way to other industries, too. When a technology or product is